MAX GAUDIN

EXECUTIVE OPERATIONS / POLITICAL TECHNOLOGY / CIVIC INFRASTRUCTURE

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EXECUTIVE PROFILE

COO, founder, and technologist with 15+ years building organizations, leading teams, and developing technology. Operating partner to the CEO of Operation Spark, a nonprofit school with a $3 million budget and approximately 20 staff; have directly managed teams of up to 10 people. Helped grow programs from 12 initial students to more than 2,000 people served and developed partnerships that raised over $3 million. Founder of Burn It Down PAC, which builds civic and political data products and campaign infrastructure.

LEADERSHIP CAPABILITIES

Organizational planning & systems • Executive operations • People management • $3M budget oversight • Partnership development • Fundraising • Program expansion • Political technology • Civic data products • Digital & SMS engagement

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

OPERATION SPARK / NEW ORLEANS | Chief Operating Officer

Sep 2024–Present

- Serve as operating partner to the CEO of a 20-person nonprofit school with a $3 million budget; have directly managed teams of up to 10 people.
- Build operating systems and AI-assisted workflows to track partnerships, student outcomes, outreach, and internal reporting across the organization.
- Oversee statewide high-school outreach and develop workforce and government partnerships for expansion into metro Atlanta.

OPERATION SPARK | Chief Operating Officer (earlier tenure); Board Chair

COO: 2014–2018 | Chair: 2019–2024

- Helped launch and scale Louisiana's largest software engineering school, growing from 12 initial students to programs serving more than 2,000 people.
- Built employer, philanthropic, and public-sector partnerships that generated more than $3 million; developed curricula, grant proposals, delivery resources, and funder reporting.
- Served as board chair from 2019 to 2024, guiding organizational strategy, governance, and executive oversight.

BURN IT DOWN PAC / LOUISIANA | Founder & Principal

2025–Present

- Founded a political technology and accountability initiative developing tools and digital infrastructure for campaigns, civic organizations, and the public.
- Lead a portfolio including BackerBase (campaign-finance intelligence), Your Turn LA (candidate recruitment), NOLA.VOTE (voter information), and Bayou Bill Watch (legislative tracking).
- Combine product strategy and implementation across campaign sites, public-records analysis, voter tools, digital fundraising, and SMS-based engagement.

ADDITIONAL EXECUTIVE, TECHNOLOGY & GROWTH EXPERIENCE

INDEPENDENT / NEW YORK + NEW ORLEANS | Principal, Strategy & Technology Consulting Feb 2022–Present

- Advise founders on technical strategy and lead MVP development, product roadmaps, and implementations for early-stage companies.
- Supported three early-stage ventures with customer validation, product design, technology decisions, and five-year financial models.
- Developed AI-enabled operations and recruiting workflows, including an SMS outreach application and employee knowledge systems.

SMEISTY / TECHSTARS-BACKED STARTUP | Co-founder & Chief Technology Officer Sep 2021–Oct 2022

- Led product and engineering at a Techstars-backed startup, coordinating technical priorities, roadmap execution, and partner delivery.
- Used customer feedback and product data to improve interfaces, architecture, and feature decisions.

SOUL ADDICT | Co-founder & Head of Growth Mar 2018–Aug 2021

- Co-founded a consumer brand and farming operation; led product launches, marketing, e-commerce, procurement, and fulfillment.
- Increased direct-to-consumer sales more than 400% in the second year and expanded retail distribution to Neiman Marcus and Urban Outfitters.

ADDITIONAL CIVIC LEADERSHIP

Institute of Politics Fellow, Class of 2026–2027 • Loyola University New Orleans

Police Community Advisory Board, New Orleans Police Department, 8th District (2025–Present). Volunteer technology educator, Voice of the Experienced (2024–Present); taught computer skills to formerly incarcerated people. Previously taught software development in Louisiana prisons.

EDUCATION

Louisiana State University / University of New Orleans • Undergraduate coursework in Hospitality, 2007–2009